THE ARABIC TEACHER · MEMBERS' WORKBOOK 1 · NOVEMBER 2026

Al-Fatihah Workbook

Ten exercises on Workshops 1–6, with answers

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ ۝ الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ ۝ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ ۝ مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ ۝ إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ ۝ اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ ۝ صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ

How to use this workbook

- Every exercise practises something the Friday workshops on Al-Fatihah have already taught. A short reminder of the rule comes first, with the workshop that taught it.
- Work in pencil. Try each exercise before you look at the answers, which are at the back.
- Stuck on a question? Reply to any workshop email and ask. That is what Ask the Teacher is for.

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Exercise 1 · What does it mean?

> Before grammar, meaning. Write the English meaning of each word from Al-Fatihah.

1. الْحَمْدُ _____
2. رَبِّ _____
3. الْعَالَمِينَ _____
4. مَالِكِ _____
5. يَوْمِ _____
6. الدِّينِ _____
7. نَعْبُدُ _____
8. نَسْتَعِينُ _____
9. اهْدِنَا _____
10. الصِّرَاطَ _____
11. الْمُسْتَقِيمَ _____
12. أَنْعَمْتَ _____

Exercise 2 · Find the root

> Most Arabic words are built on a **root** of three letters that carries the basic meaning. Extra letters (like الْ al-, مُسْتَ musta- or نَ na-) are added around it. (Workshops 1–6)
>
> Write the three root letters of each word, with spaces between them, the way the workshops do: ر ح م.

Word	Meaning	Root	Word	Meaning	Root
الرَّحِيمِ	the Ever-Merciful		نَسْتَعِينُ	we ask for help	
الْحَمْدُ	praise		اهْدِ	guide	
رَبِّ	Lord		الْمُسْتَقِيمَ	the straight	
مَالِكِ	Master		أَنْعَمْتَ	You have blessed	
الدِّينِ	Recompense		الْمَغْضُوبِ	those under anger	
نَعْبُدُ	we worship		الضَّالِّينَ	those gone astray	

Hint for رَبّ and ضَالّ: the shadda (double mark) hides a doubled letter.

Exercise 3 · Match the pattern

> A **pattern** is the shape the root letters are poured into. The letters ف ع ل stand for the three root letters. Each pattern adds a meaning: فَعْلَان (fa'laan) a quality at its fullest · فَعِيل (fa'eel) a lasting quality · فَاعِل (faa'il) the one who does the action · مَفْعُول (maf'ool) the one the action is done to · مُسْتَفْعِل (mustaf'il) a doer of Form X. (Workshops 1, 3, 5, 6)

A. Write the pattern of each word from Al-Fatihah.

1. الرَّحْمٰن the Most Merciful _____
2. الرَّحِيم the Ever-Merciful _____
3. مَالِك Master, Owner _____
4. الْمَغْضُوب the one under anger _____
5. الْمُسْتَقِيم the straight _____
6. ضَالّ one gone astray _____

B. These words are new, but their patterns are not. Write the pattern, then the meaning the pattern gives.

Word	Root and its meaning	Pattern	So the word means…
عَالِم	ع ل م knowing		
عَلِيم	ع ل م knowing		
خَالِق	خ ل ق creating		
مَكْتُوب	ك ت ب writing		
غَضْبَان	غ ض ب anger		

Exercise 4 · Which case, and why?

A noun's last vowel shows its **case**: nominative (*marfoo'*, damma -u), accusative (*mansoob*, fatha -a) or genitive (*majroor*, kasra -i). For the sound masculine plural the endings are وْنَ (-oona) in the nominative and ينَ (-eena) in the other two. Causes you have met: a **subject** of a nominal sentence is nominative; an **object** is accusative; a noun after a **preposition** or as the second noun of a **possessive pair** is genitive; an **adjective**, or a word standing in for another (*badal*), **copies** the case of its noun. (Workshops 1–6)

Word (ayah)	Meaning	Case	Why? (one reason)
الْحَمْدُ (1:2)	praise		
اللَّهِ in لِلَّهِ (1:2)	Allah		
رَبِّ (1:2)	Lord		
الْعَالَمِينَ (1:2)	the worlds		
يَوْمِ (1:4)	Day		
الصِّرَاطَ (1:6)	the path		
الْمُسْتَقِيمَ (1:6)	the straight		
صِرَاطَ (1:7)	path		
غَيْرِ (1:7)	not, other than		
الضَّالِّينَ (1:7)	those gone astray		

Exercise 5 · Same word, different ending

> A word does not have one fixed ending. Its ending changes with its job in the sentence. One more thing an adjective copies: if its noun has الْ (al-, "the"), the adjective has it too; if the noun has none, the adjective has none.

1. In the Basmala it is الرَّحْمٰنِ (ar-Rahmani), but in الرَّحْمٰنُ ۝ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ "The Most Merciful taught the Qur'an" (55:1–2) it is الرَّحْمٰنُ (ar-Rahmanu). Why?

2. In 1:4 it is يَوْمِ (yawmi), but in وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا يَوْمُ الدِّينِ "And what will make you know what the Day of Recompense is?" (82:17) it is يَوْمُ (yawmu). Why?

3. In 1:6 we read الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ "the straight path". In 2:213 we read إِلَىٰ صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ "to a straight path" (إِلَىٰ ilaa = to, a preposition).
   a. Why do both words end in kasra in 2:213?
   b. Why do they have no الْ, and end in tanween with kasra (-in) instead?

Exercise 6 · Possessive chains

> In a **possessive pair** (*idafa*) "the X of Y", the first noun (*mudaf*) loses its الْ and its tanween, and the second noun (*mudaf ilayh*) is genitive. A chain can be three nouns long. (Workshops 1, 2, 3, 6)

1. Find a possessive pair in each ayah. Write the first noun and the second noun.

Ayah	First noun (*mudaf*)	Second noun (*mudaf ilayh*)
1:1		
1:2		
1:7 (two pairs)		

2. In مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ "Master of the Day of Recompense" (1:4), one word is *both* a second noun and a first noun. Which, and how?
3. A student writes الْمَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ, and another writes مَالِكٍ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ. What is wrong with each?

Exercise 7 · Sentences with no verb

> A **nominal sentence** (*jumla ismiyya*) has a **subject** (*mubtada*) and a **predicate** (*khabar*), and needs no word for "is". When the predicate is a noun, it is nominative like the subject. A preposition with its noun, like لِلَّهِ "for Allah", can also be the predicate. (Workshop 2)
> Underline the subject once and the predicate twice.

1. الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ All praise belongs to Allah, Lord of all the worlds. (1:2)
2. اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ Allah is the One all depend on. (112:2) (الصَّمَد the One all depend on)
3. وَالْأَمْرُ يَوْمَئِذٍ لِلَّهِ and the command, that Day, is Allah's. (82:19) (الْأَمْر the command; يَوْمَئِذٍ on that Day, a time word: leave it aside when you look for the subject and predicate)

4. Why does the Qur'an say الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ and not أَحْمَدُ اللَّهَ "I praise Allah"? One sentence.

Exercise 8 · Verbs and who does them

> In Arabic the subject of a verb is often **inside the verb**. In the present tense a prefix shows it: أَ (a-) I · نَ (na-) we · تَ (ta-) you · يَ (ya-) he; "you" speaking to many adds ونَ (-oona) at the end as well. In the past tense an ending shows it: تَ (-ta) you. A command's subject "you" is understood. (Workshops 4, 5, 6)

Verb	Meaning	Past, present or command?	Who does it?	What shows it?
نَعْبُدُ (1:5)	we worship			
نَسْتَعِينُ (1:5)	we ask for help			
اهْدِ (1:6)	guide			
أَنْعَمْتَ (1:7)	You have blessed			
أَعْبُدُ (109:2)	I worship			
تَعْبُدُونَ (109:2)	you (all) worship			

109:2 in full: لَا أَعْبُدُ مَا تَعْبُدُونَ "I do not worship what you worship." (لَا not; مَا what)

Exercise 9 · Pronouns and word order

> An **attached pronoun** is joined to the end of a word: كَ (-ka) you, نَا (-naa) us, هِمْ (-him) them. A **detached pronoun** stands alone, like إِيَّاكَ (iyyaaka) "you" as an object. Putting the object first gives the meaning "only". (Workshops 4, 5, 6)

1. Write نَعْبُدُ إِيَّاكَ in the ordinary order, with an attached pronoun. _____ What meaning is lost? _____
2. In اهْدِنَا "guide us", is نَا attached or detached? _____ What is its job? _____
3. In أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ "You have blessed them" (1:7), who does هِمْ refer back to? _____
4. Ayahs 2–4 speak *about* Allah; ayah 5 speaks *to* Him. Which letter in ayah 5 makes the change? _____

Exercise 10 · Root hunt

> Each verse below has a word from a root you met in Al-Fatihah. Find the word, write its root, and name the word in Al-Fatihah that shares it.

Verse	Word	Root	Word in Al-Fatihah
مَلِكِ النَّاسِ King of mankind (114:2)			
لَا أَعْبُدُ مَا تَعْبُدُونَ I do not worship what you worship (109:2)			
وَاسْتَعِينُوا بِالصَّبْرِ وَالصَّلَاةِ And seek help through patience and prayer (2:45)			
إِنَّ هَٰذَا الْقُرْآنَ يَهْدِي لِلَّتِي هِيَ أَقْوَمُ This Qur'an guides to what is most upright (17:9) (two words)			
الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِمْ those whom Allah has blessed (4:69)			
الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي خَلَقَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ All praise belongs to Allah, who created the heavens and the earth (6:1)			

Bonus: 6:1 has one more root from Exercise 3. Which word, and which root?

Answers

Exercise 1

1. praise (all praise)
2. Lord
3. the worlds
4. Master, Owner
5. Day
6. Recompense, Judgement
7. we worship
8. we ask for help
9. guide us
10. the path
11. the straight
12. You have blessed

Exercise 2

ر ح م الرَّحِيمِ

ح م د الْحَمْدُ

ر ب ب رَبِّ (doubled)

م ل ك مَالِكِ

د ي ن الدِّينِ

ع ب د نَعْبُدُ

ع و ن نَسْتَعِينُ

ه د ي اهْدِ

ق و م الْمُسْتَقِيمَ

ن ع م أَنْعَمْتَ

غ ض ب الْمَغْضُوبِ

ض ل ل الضَّالِّينَ (doubled)

Exercise 3

A. 1. فَعْلَان · 2. فَعِيل · 3. فَاعِل · 4. مَفْعُول · 5. مُسْتَفْعِل · 6. فَاعِل (ضَالِل daalil, with the two ل merged into ضَالّ)

B. فَاعِل عَالِم: one who knows · فَعِيل عَلِيم: always knowing, All-Knowing · فَاعِل خَالِق: one who creates, Creator · مَفْعُول مَكْتُوب: something written · فَعْلَان غَضْبَان: full of anger (Musa in 7:150)

Exercise 4

1. الْحَمْدُ nominative: the subject (*mubtada*) of a nominal sentence.
2. اللَّهِ genitive: after the preposition لِ (li) "for".
3. رَبِّ genitive: it describes اللَّهِ and copies its case.
4. الْعَالَمِينَ genitive (ينَ -eena): second noun of the pair رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ "Lord of the worlds".
5. يَوْمِ genitive: second noun of the pair مَالِكِ يَوْمِ "Master of the Day".
6. الصِّرَاطَ accusative: the second object of اهْدِ "guide".
7. الْمُسْتَقِيمَ accusative: an adjective of الصِّرَاطَ, so it copies its case.
8. صِرَاطَ accusative: it stands in for (*badal*) الصِّرَاطَ of ayah 6 and copies its case.
9. غَيْرِ genitive: it describes الَّذِينَ "those who", which is in the genitive position.
10. الضَّالِّينَ genitive (ينَ -eena): joined by وَ "and" to الْمَغْضُوبِ, it shares its case.

Exercise 5

1. In the Basmala, الرَّحْمَٰنِ describes اللَّهِ, which is genitive, so it is genitive too. In 55:1 it is the subject of a nominal sentence, so it is nominative.
2. In 1:4, يَوْمِ is the second noun of the pair مَالِكِ يَوْمِ, so it is genitive. In 82:17 it is part of the nominal sentence مَا يَوْمُ الدِّينِ "what is the Day of Recompense?", and nothing makes it genitive, so it is nominative.
3. (a) صِرَاطٍ comes after the preposition إِلَى "to", so it is genitive; مُسْتَقِيمٍ describes it and copies its case. (b) Here the meaning is "*a* straight path", so صِرَاط has no الْ, and a noun without الْ takes tanween (-in in the genitive). The adjective copies that too: no الْ, tanween -in.

Exercise 6

1. 1:1 اسْمِ, then اللَّهِ "the name of Allah" · 1:2 رَبِّ, then الْعَالَمِينَ "Lord of the worlds" · 1:7 صِرَاطَ, then الَّذِينَ "the path of those …", and غَيْرِ, then الْمَغْضُوبِ "not (of) those under anger". (1:4 has a chain too: see question 2.)
2. يَوْمِ: it is the second noun after مَالِكِ (so it is genitive), and the first noun before الدِّينِ (so it has no الْ and no tanween).
3. الْمَالِكِ: a first noun (*mudaf*) never takes الْ. مَالِكٍ: a first noun never takes tanween. Both must be مَالِكِ.

Exercise 7

1. Subject الْحَمْدُ; predicate لِلَّهِ. (رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ describes Allah.)
2. Subject اللَّهُ; predicate الصَّمَدُ. Both are nominative.
3. Subject الْأَمْرُ; predicate لِلَّهِ.
4. A sentence with a verb, "I praise Allah", ties the praise to one speaker at one time. The nominal sentence states it as a lasting truth: all praise belongs to Allah, whoever praises and whenever.

Exercise 8

Verb	Type	Who	Shown by
نَعْبُدُ	present	we	prefix نَ (na-)
نَسْتَعِينُ	present	we	prefix نَ (na-)
اهْدِ	command (a prayer here)	you (Allah is addressed)	understood, not written
أَنْعَمْتَ	past	you	ending تَ (-ta)
أَعْبُدُ	present	I	prefix أَ (a-)
تَعْبُدُونَ	present	you (many)	prefix تَ (ta-) + ending ونَ (-oona)

Exercise 9

1. نَعْبُدُكَ (na'buduka) "we worship You". Lost: the meaning "You *alone*"; putting the object first restricts the worship to Allah.
2. Attached. It is the first object of اهْدِ: "guide *us*". (The second object is الصِّرَاطَ.)
3. الَّذِينَ "those who". It is the link back (*'a'id*) that every relative clause needs.
4. كَ (-ka) "You" in إِيَّاكَ: the Surah now speaks to Allah directly.

Exercise 10

Verse	Word	Root	In Al-Fatihah
114:2	مَلِكِ	م ل ك	مَالِكِ
109:2	أَعْبُدُ ، تَعْبُدُونَ	ع ب د	نَعْبُدُ
2:45	اسْتَعِينُوا	ع و ن	نَسْتَعِينُ
17:9	يَهْدِي ، أَقْوَمُ	ه د ي ، ق و م	اهْدِنَا ، الْمُسْتَقِيمَ
4:69	أَنْعَمَ	ن ع م	أَنْعَمْتَ
6:1	الْحَمْدُ	ح م د	الْحَمْدُ

Bonus: خَلَقَ "He created", root خ ل ق, the root of خَالِق "Creator" in Exercise 3.

Next month's workbook follows the next set of Friday workshops. Questions? Reply to any workshop email.

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